CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 6

PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- to schedule dog training lessons
- to purchase some souvenirs
- to arrange for an overnight trip
- to pay for a dogsled excursion

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- Her card is refused.
- She used a debit card.
- They don't accept credit cards.
- Her credit card expired.

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- falling into the lake
- knowing where to go
- going too fast
- paying for the drive

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- She moves from side to side.
- She steps on the brake.
- She tells the dogs to stop.
- She pulls the reigns.

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- to scare the woman
- to confuse the woman
- to amuse the woman
- to reassure the woman

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- for safety reasons
- to give directions
- the woman asked him to
- to help the woman stop

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- She wanted to thank the driver.
- It was very annoying.
- She was interested in driving one.
- It frightened the dogs.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- Try it only if you can get a special rate.
- It is great for adventurous people.
- Consider riding the sled as a passenger.
- It is more suited to children than adults.

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- a newspaper subscription
- a book series
- a gym membership
- a telephone plan

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- Manaz was a customer in the past.
- He is a regular customer.
- His name was on her list.
- Manaz filled out an application form.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- interested
- suspicious
- pleased
- upset

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- She has never heard the name "Amir" before.
- She is interested in the meanings of names.
- She is going to write him an email.
- She would like to call him by his name.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- the entire newspaper
- only local news stories
- a selection of articles
- the sports highlights

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- He wants her to replace another employee.
- He wants her to organize the classroom renovations.
- He wants her to bring a package to someone in Finance.
- He wants her to add a new task to her duties.

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- It is currently having financial difficulties.
- It makes a lot of money renting rooms.
- It recently purchased new booking software.
- It holds regular first aid courses for students.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- a request for more than one room
- a refusal to pay the rental fee
- a request for a room near a washroom
- a complaint about the room sizes

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- so he can prepare the room
- so he can reschedule the classes
- so he can confirm the booking
- so he can send an invoice

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- contact her co-worker
- call the Community Centre
- offer an alternate date
- decline the booking request

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- confused
- confident
- angry
- surprised

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. One of the magician's tricks involved _____
- giving away a $20 bill.
- copying a $20 bill.
- making a $20 bill disappear.
- tearing up a $20 bill.

2. Before giving the magician money, Patricia _____
- asked her father for another $20 bill.
- took a picture of her $20 bill.
- took a picture of the magician.
- wrote down the serial number.

3. Patricia noticed that the new bill _____
- had different numbers.
- had bigger numbers.
- had a serial number.
- had the same number.

4. Patricia knew about counterfeit from _____
- a course on currency.
- a museum tour.
- a school project.
- training in fake money.

5. The magician was in trouble because he _____
- stole money from the bank.
- stole money from his audience.
- tore a $20 bill into pieces.
- used Patricia's $20 bill in his show.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. What aspect of the fundraiser are the three colleagues debating?
- the recipient of the funds
- the format of the event
- the schedule of the auction
- the purpose of the fundraiser

2. Why are the three colleagues planning a fundraiser?
- Eric's wife asked the company for help.
- The hospital wards are in bad condition.
- Their company regularly organizes fundraisers.
- The employees enjoy participating in silent auctions.

3. What stage are the three colleagues at in their planning?
- generating ideas
- finalizing details
- distributing tasks
- awaiting approval

4. What is Eric pleased about?
- the new fundraising strategy
- the chosen recipient of the funds
- the postponed meeting time
- the traditional auction system

5. Which statement is true about a traditional silent auction?
- Bidders know how much each person bids.
- The highest bidders are notified immediately.
- It requires choosing an identification number.
- Bidders can make high bids for items they want.

6. Why does Marie dislike the change that Isabella suggested?
- It will make the auction longer.
- It will confuse experienced bidders.
- It will encourage bidders to bid low.
- It will make the auction less efficient.

PART 5

7. Why does Isabella dislike traditional silent auctions?

- ◯ The system is difficult to understand.
- ◯ The bidding is too competitive.
- ◯ Bidders' names are made public.
- ◯ It takes too long to process the results.

8. How will the group's indecision be resolved?

- ◯ They will do further research.
- ◯ They will vote on the matter.
- ◯ They will request outside input.
- ◯ They will continue the debate later.

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. Nelson has requested that city council _____

- ◯ approve a plan to redevelop the vacant land.
- ◯ maintain the zoning bylaw for an area of land.
- ◯ work to reduce urban sprawl.
- ◯ clean up a polluted local creek.

2. According to the mother of two, high-density apartment buildings _____

- ◯ are a good option for families with children.
- ◯ can help to preserve green space.
- ◯ could be built in addition to a park.
- ◯ could put her community at risk.

3. Stanley Creek _____

- ◯ has been rehabilitated by the surrounding community.
- ◯ is an obstacle to development in the area.
- ◯ is endangered by the development proposal.
- ◯ may be developed into a nature walkway.

4. Nelson Development Company envisions a _____

- ◯ business community with several large retail chain stores.
- ◯ compact community with a vibrant local economy.
- ◯ mixed community combining high-rise offices and apartments.
- ◯ sprawling residential community for families with children.

5. The city councillor believes that _____

- ◯ both economic and community interests can be satisfied.
- ◯ development of the area may lead to greenland expansion.
- ◯ more rezoning should be done along the north bank of the river.
- ◯ Stanley Creek is a problematic location for a park.

6. If city council approves Nelson's current proposal, _____

- ◯ Mother of two, Eleanor Wentworth, will be disappointed.
- ◯ City Councillor, Emma Orr, will feel the need for more negotiations.
- ◯ Developer Nelson will worry about the building costs.
- ◯ The children will be happy with their new play area.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	to pay for a dogsled excursion
Question 2	Her card is refused.
Question 3	falling into the lake
Question 4	She steps on the brake.
Question 5	to reassure the woman
Question 6	for safety reasons
Question 7	It was very annoying.
Question 8	Consider riding the sled as a passenger.

PART 2	
Question 1	a newspaper subscription
Question 2	Manaz was a customer in the past.
Question 3	suspicious
Question 4	She would like to call him by his name.
Question 5	a selection of articles

PART 3	
Question 1	He wants her to add a new task to her duties.
Question 2	It is currently having financial difficulties.
Question 3	a request for a room near a washroom
Question 4	so he can send an invoice
Question 5	contact her co-worker
Question 6	confident

PART 4	
Question 1	tearing up a $20 bill.
Question 2	took a picture of her $20 bill.
Question 3	had different numbers.
Question 4	a school project.
Question 5	stole money from his audience.

PART 5	
Question 1	the format of the event
Question 2	Their company regularly organizes fundraisers.
Question 3	generating ideas
Question 4	the chosen recipient of the funds
Question 5	Bidders can make high bids for items they want.
Question 6	It will encourage bidders to bid low.
Question 7	It takes too long to process the results.
Question 8	They will request outside input.

PART 6	
Question 1	approve a plan to redevelop the vacant land.
Question 2	could put her community at risk.
Question 3	may be developed into a nature walkway.
Question 4	compact community with a vibrant local economy.
Question 5	both economic and community interests can be satisfied.
Question 6	Mother of two, Eleanor Wentworth, will be disappointed.

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between two people, a man and a woman, who are at a dogsled tour business.

Section 1:

WOMAN: Hello, is this where I can book a dogsled ride?

MAN: It is! Are you looking to ride as a passenger, or would you like to drive your own?

WOMAN: I can drive my own dogsled? But . . . I don't know how . . .

MAN: Our dogs are very well trained. I'll tell you everything you need to know.

WOMAN: Okay, sign me up! For the drive, not the ride, that is.

MAN: And would you like the hour-long trip or the overnight trip?

WOMAN: The hour-long trip please.

MAN: That'll be $75 then. Will you be paying by credit card?

WOMAN: Yes. Just give me a second to find it. It always gets lost at the bottom of my purse. Ahh, here it is.

MAN: Thanks . . . Now we just need you to read and sign this waiver. Hm . . . I'm afraid your credit card has been declined.

WOMAN: Oh. I'm sorry—I forgot I put several souvenirs on it last night. Here, try this card instead.

Now answer questions 1-2.

1. What is the main purpose of this interaction?
2. What is the problem with her payment?

Section 2:

WOMAN: Wow! The dogs are big! Are they friendly?

MAN: Absolutely . . . they're real people-pleasers! Ok, now, step onto the sled, yes, like that, and hold on to the handles. Good. Now bend your knees a little bit, and move from side to side, that's right. That's what the ride will be like.

WOMAN: How do I tell the dogs where to go?

MAN: You won't need to. They're trained to run on the track around the lake.

WOMAN: Around the lake? What if they run onto the lake? I don't want to fall through the ice!

MAN: Don't worry . . . even if the dogs did run onto the lake, its frozen solid.

WOMAN: I don't know . . . even if ice looks frozen there can still be thin patches.

MAN: Well, yes . . . But on this lake, heavy trucks regularly drive over even the thinnest areas . . . so I'm pretty sure it is safe enough for you and few dogs

WOMAN: Okay . . .

MAN: But if you're ever nervous and want to stop or slow down, just step with both feet onto the brake.

Now answer questions 3-5.

3. What is the woman's main concern?
4. How does she stop the dogsled?
5. Why does the man joke about thin ice?

Transcripts

Section 3:

WOMAN: Wow! That was amazing! But someone on a snowmobile followed me around the whole time—it was loud!

MAN: That was me! We do that for the drive-your-own rides. Just in case.

WOMAN: Oh . . . I guess I should say thank you then, but, well, the noise.

MAN: Yes, the noise really does carry. If you come back again, maybe you would prefer the dogsled ride. Without the snowmobile, it's a lot more peaceful.

WOMAN: Yes, I'll definitely consider that. Do you by any chance have a special rate for groups? My daughter's eighth birthday is coming up . . . she and her friends would love this.

MAN: Of course! Come inside and we can discuss the prices.

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. Why did the man follow her?
7. Why did the woman mention the snowmobile?
8. What would the woman likely tell others about her experience?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You will hear a telephone conversation between a woman and a customer.

WOMAN: Hello, may I please speak to Manaz?

MAN: Manaz isn't home at the moment. Can I take a message?

WOMAN: I'm calling from The Gazette. Manaz was a subscriber last year, and we're now offering a special promotion for our former customers.

MAN: Oh, I see. Well, Manaz will be home later this afternoon . . .

WOMAN: It is a very good deal we are offering. Perhaps you would also be interested. Can I tell you a little bit more about it?

MAN: Well, I'm a little bit, um . . . busy . . . but -

WOMAN: It will only take a few minutes!

MAN: Sure. I guess so.

WOMAN: Wonderful! What we're offering is daily delivery of The Gazette for the price of the weekend papers only. What that means is you'll get seven days of delivery, for the price of just two days! So today, for a limited time only, it's a weekly cost of only $3.75. That's a 50% discount off our normal price of $7.50.

MAN: That does sound like a good deal . . . and I do enjoy reading the free Gazette articles available online. It might be nice to have access to the whole newspaper though . . . instead of just one article from each section. But, I'm always wary of promotions that are for a limited time only. When will the price go up? And can I cancel when it does?

WOMAN: I understand your concerns. The price will go up after three months, but you can cancel at any time. You've really got nothing to lose by trying it out.

MAN: Hmm . . . You've almost convinced me, but I'd like to talk to Manaz first and we'll decide together. Can you call us back later this week?

WOMAN: Absolutely. I will call later this week. And who should I ask for when I call?

MAN: You can ask for either me or Manaz.

WOMAN: I don't know your name.

MAN: Oh, of course, yeah. My name is Amir.

WOMAN: Thank you, Amir. I will be in touch later this week.

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. What does the woman want to sell?
2. Why is the woman offering Amir this promotion?
3. How does Amir feel about limited-time promotions?
4. Why does the woman say, "I don't know your name"?
5. What content does The Gazette publish online?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman who work at a university. The man, who is the woman's supervisor, has stopped to speak to the woman.

MAN: Cheryl, do you have a minute? You might not have heard, but the university has decided to rent out its classrooms to the public when not in use by a course. We're hoping to raise funds for some much-needed renovations. Diane will continue to book the rooms for our courses, but I'd like you to handle queries from the community.

WOMAN: Sure. What's involved? I'm not too familiar with the booking software. I've only used it once.

MAN: No worries. First, open the booking form, see? Just ask for their information and fill it in. The person's name, address, phone number, etc.

WOMAN: That's easy enough. Will they already know which room they want to book?

MAN: No, you'll have to help them figure that out. Just open up the rooms list, here. It lists all the rooms, indicating size, location, and so on.

WOMAN: I think I'll print that list and go check out the rooms around campus. It'll give me a better idea of what to recommend.

MAN: Good idea. For example, if they're going to give a lecture, they'll want one of the auditoriums. If they're holding a workshop, one of the classrooms. And, of course, some classrooms have tables and chairs that can be moved, others have desks bolted into the floor . . .

WOMAN: So, let's say someone is holding a First Aid Certification course, they'd probably want a medium sized classroom and to be able to move the tables and chairs. I think I got it. When I walk around later, I'll also make note of which rooms are near washrooms, which ones near a main entrance. You never know what people will want.

MAN: Excellent. Now the price list is here.

WOMAN: Do they send the payment to us?

MAN: No, once the booking form is complete, send a copy to them, and a copy to Michael, in Finance. He'll send them an invoice . . . and follow-up if they don't pay on time.

WOMAN: Okay, anything else? If what they want isn't available, shall I suggest they contact the Community Center?

MAN: No. Tell them you'll get back to them, then call Diane. She may be able to reschedule the class using the requested room. We really need the revenue, so I'd like to pursue that option first.

WOMAN: Okay, no problem!

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. Why does the man come speak to the woman?
2. What is likely true about the university?
3. What does the woman think might occur?
4. Why would she send a copy of the booking form to Michael?
5. If the room is already booked, what will the woman do?
6. How does the woman feel about the man's request?

PART 4

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news story about a magician.

Street magician Carson Witt has been arrested and charged with stealing from his audiences. The 26-year-old performer has been traveling around Canada for the last four months, amazing people with his sleight of hand. One of his best-known tricks is to ask an audience member for a twenty-dollar bill, rip it into shreds, then pull the same bill unharmed out of an orange. Witt was performing at the Winnipeg Folk Festival when he got caught. Twelve-year-old Patricia Wu had the insight to take a picture of the serial number of her twenty-dollar bill with her dad's cell phone before she handed it over to Witt. When he returned it to Patricia, she announced it wasn't the same tracking number. She'd been doing a school project on counterfeit bills and noted that the new $20 bill didn't have raised ink on the large number of the bill like it should have. She told her father, who alerted security. Witt was found with a stack of fake twenties in his possession. Although this does not happen regularly, police warn festival goers to be careful with their money.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a discussion among three colleagues. There are two women and one man. They are in a meeting room at their workplace.

Eric: Hey Isabella, Marie. Sorry I'm late. Hey, I hear our company is thinking about having a fundraiser for the children's hospital. I hope so, as it's a great cause. I'm ready to get cracking!

Isabella: I'm glad to hear your enthusiasm! Yes, it's our team's turn to organize the fundraiser. Our manager thinks a worthy recipient is the children's hospital because some of the wards need refurbishing.

Eric: Hmm, that's interesting. My wife's a nurse there and she mentioned up-to-date equipment is a priority. But I'm not sure what equipment that is; I could check and find out.

Isabella: OK, why don't we see about changing the purpose and aim at raising money for the children's hospital, but they can use it according to their priorities list. Is that better?

Marie: Yes, much better, Isabella, as that gives us more flexibility. Are we going to have a silent auction?

Eric: What's a silent auction?

Marie: Well, it's a lot less confrontational than a regular auction. Each item is numbered and displayed. And there's a starting price for each bid. If you're interested in the item, you put an amount down on a piece of paper—plus your name and phone number—and then fold the piece of paper in half, and put it into the bidding jar. The highest bid at the end wins.

Isabella: But I was thinking maybe we could change the bidding system. We could assign bidders a personal code number. They write their number, and their bid, on a chart next to the item that they want. Everyone would see the chart and the bidding amounts, but no names. The traditional silent auction drives me crazy because I never know how much to bid.

Marie: Although, I wonder if people will be inclined to bid less because they can see what everybody else is bidding. What I really like about a traditional auction is that if you're really interested in an item, you just bid really high to ensure that you get it.

Eric: On the other hand, if two or three people want it, they can keep bidding higher and higher if they know the amount already bid.

Isabella: Exactly. And the revised system would save everyone a lot of time, too. We wouldn't have to sort through all the bid papers. The highest bid would be crystal clear because we identify the winning bidder by checking our personal codes list. Then buyers pay for the item at the end of the evening, and they take it with them.

Marie: Well, do we have to make this decision ourselves, or could we consult the manager? I think we need a buy-in from everyone in order to make such a big change.

Isabella: I'll talk to the manager this afternoon. Let's meet at the same time tomorrow to start planning the details.

Marie and Eric: OK.

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about community development.

Good morning, and welcome to Monday's edition of the Daily Buzz. This is Nadia Cooper reporting. Calgary city council is currently negotiating a controversial proposal in relation to the demolition of Henley Car Factory, an abandoned factory located at the east edge of town. Developer George Nelson, of Nelson Development Company, feels that the area has significant economic potential and has put forward a proposal to develop several apartment buildings and retail shops on the newly cleared land. Accordingly, he has requested that the area be rezoned for residential and retail space.

However, not all members of the community are happy with this request. Eleanor Wentworth, a high school teacher and mother of two, has spearheaded a campaign against further development in the area, stating that community, rather than economic interests should take precedence. She argues that the area is primarily composed of families with children who need a safe place to play and that, as it is, there is already insufficient green space. Furthermore, she emphasizes that they live in a tight-knit community and fears that a more densely populated neighbourhood could put this at risk, since living in a highly populated area often makes it less likely that one will know their neighbours. As such, Wentworth and her supporters would, instead, like to see the old car factory replaced by a large park.

Nelson has countered such criticisms by stating that his proposal does, in fact, leave adequate room for green space. Included in the proposal, is the cleaning up of Stanley creek, a nearby creek which has long been clogged with garbage. The rehabilitated creek would then be turned into a nature walkway for residents. Additionally, Nelson points out that the development of high-density apartment buildings actually helps preserve green space by preventing urban sprawl. Furthermore, with regards to retail operations, he plans for no more than four or five small, family-owned shops. This, he insists, would actually help to build community by maintaining a localized economy.

City Council member Emma Orr wonders if there is the potential for compromise within the opposing camps. She believes the factory area is large enough to hold both a medium-sized park as well as several apartment buildings or shops. Since the creek runs in a fairly straight line along the north side of the factory, she suggests that the park be built alongside the creek. This would maintain adequate green space for both a walking trail as well as a play area for children and youth. The rest of the land could then be rezoned for residential and retail purposes. She is currently discussing her proposal with both parties.